

GUILLERMO & PILAR · THE 45-DAY CHALLENGE

The 45-Day Meal Plan



Everything you eat for the next 45 days: high in protein, easy to keep, and built to lose fat while you hold on to your muscle. Real food, a short menu, and two portion sizes made for each of you.

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Read this through slowly and do not skip a page: it is short on purpose, and every part fits together, so read it once from start to finish to understand it all. I have kept it as simple as I possibly can, and you still get three versions of every meal, so the day you are fed up with one, you just switch to another.

Two ways to run this

Path 1: the strict 45-day plan (the challenge). For the next 45 days you follow the plan tightly: hit your calorie target most days, keep the protein high, and take only the one free meal every 2 weeks. This is where the real change happens.

Path 2: the relaxed way. The exact same menu, just looser: aim for the target most days, allow a few more free meals, do not stress a slip. Slower, but very easy to live with. Perfect for after the 45 days, or if strict ever feels like too much.

A strict plan is NOT a boring one. Even on the strict path you get a small menu: **3 breakfasts, 3 lunches, 3 dinners.** Each day you pick one from each, in any order. Do not fancy one today? Swap it. The structure is fixed, the choice is yours. Every meal shows two portion sizes: one for Pilar, a bigger one for Guillermo.

The plan is only half of it: move

Eating gets the weight off. What you do with your body decides what KIND of weight comes off. The strongest, best-proven result comes from three things together:

1. **This plan** (the calorie deficit, protein high). Drives the fat loss.
2. **A little strength training** (push-ups, a kettlebell, simple bodyweight work 2 to 3 times a week). This keeps and even builds muscle while you lose fat, so you end up leaner and stronger, not just lighter.
3. **Regular walks.** Extra burn with almost no downside, and they help your head as much as your waist.

Diet alone shrinks you. Diet plus a bit of strength plus walks reshapes you.

Read this first: the rules that make it work

- 1

Protein leads the plate. When you eat below your calories, your body can burn fat OR muscle. Protein tells it to burn fat and keep the muscle, so you get leaner and stronger, not just lighter. Daily target: **Guillermo about 160 g, Pilar about 110 g.** That is why chicken, fish, eggs and egg whites take the big part of the plate, and rice or pasta become the small side.
- 2

Your calories a day. Aim inside your band. The strict plan aims at the low end, the relaxed way sits at the high end.

PERSON	YOUR DAILY BAND	STRICT AIMS AT	NEVER GO BELOW
Guillermo	2,200 to 2,400 kcal	~2,200 kcal	1,600 kcal
Pilar	1,300 to 1,500 kcal	~1,300 kcal	1,200 kcal

Do not cut harder than about 500 kcal below your normal burn: past that the body burns muscle and your energy for the site tanks. Moderate cut + protein + a bit of training beats starving, every time.
- 3

Two portion sizes, one kitchen. Pilar and Guillermo eat the same dishes. Guillermo just gets a bigger plate, because a man on a building site burns close to 900 kcal a day more. Cook once, serve two sizes. The grams below are a start, not a law.
- 4

Eat to "not hungry", not to "stuffed". Your gut tells your brain it is full through hormones (CCK, PYY), and that signal arrives late: about 15 to 20 minutes after you start. So the fix is simple and proven: **a glass of water before the meal, eat slowly, then wait.** In one trial, water before meals meant 4.3 kg more weight loss over 12 weeks.
- 5

Vegetables are free, and required at lunch and dinner. Mostly water: big volume, almost no calories. You never weigh the vegetables.
- 6

Water 2 to 3 litres a day. Weigh 3 times a week (morning, after the toilet, before eating) and trust only the weekly average, not a single day.
- 7

One free meal every 2 weeks. Not a free day, a free meal. Enjoy it fully, then the next meal you are back on plan. No "making up for it".
- 8

Guillermo, the weekend is the trap. Off the scaffolding you burn far less, so keep the base plan and skip the workday extras. Same food that is fine Monday is a surplus Sunday.

Optional, nice to have, not required: a daily omega-3, vitamin D in winter, 5 g creatine if you train, magnesium at night. The plan works without any of them.

Breakfast: pick 1

Two of these live in jars in the fridge. On a work morning Guillermo opens the fridge, grabs a jar, and leaves. Prep 4 to 5 at once on Sunday.

B1 • Overnight oats and yogurt jar

Sweet, no cooking, keeps about 4 days. Add fresh berries and nuts in the morning.

INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Oats	45 g	70 g
High-protein yogurt	175 g	250 g
Blueberries	80 g	100 g
Walnuts	12 g	20 g
Per serving	~400 kcal • 26 g P	~600 kcal • 37 g P

B2 • Egg-white omelette jar

Pure egg whites, no yolk: the lean savory one. Keeps about 5 days, toppings separate. Guillermo eats it cold or warms it 40 seconds. Want it more filling? Add a slice of wholegrain toast.

INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Egg whites (claras)	200 g	300 g
Ham cubes (serrano or turkey)	30 g	40 g
Spinach + onion	free	free
Olive oil	5 g	8 g
Cooked rice	none	80 g
Per serving	~230 kcal • 31 g P	~450 kcal • 47 g P

B3 • Sweet potato and chicken hash

Warm and savory, a different protein from the egg breakfasts. Batch the chicken on Sunday. Prefer egg? Swap the chicken for 100 to 150 g egg whites (the sweet-potato-and-egg version).

INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Cooked chicken (or turkey)	100 g	160 g
Sweet potato	120 g	180 g
Spinach	free	free
Olive oil	3 g	5 g
Per serving	~300 kcal • 32 g P	~460 kcal • 50 g P

Lunch: pick 1 (the anchor meal)

Always the same build: a big piece of protein, a mountain of vegetables, and a small portion of smart carbs. Protein takes the biggest part of the plate.

L1 • Oven chicken + sweet potato + veg		
The batch hero. Roast a big tray, it covers 2 to 3 days of lunches.		
INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Chicken (breast or thigh)	150 g	220 g
Sweet potato	130 g	180 g
Vegetables	free	free
Olive oil	6 g	10 g
Per serving	~470 kcal • 46 g P	~640 kcal • 68 g P

L2 • Euskal Okela lean beef		
1 to 2 times a week only. Look for the Eusko Label at the butcher: grass-fed, zero-km Basque beef.		
INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Lean beef (steak or mince)	110 g	180 g
Grilled vegetables	free	free
Potato	80 g	120 g
Olive oil	5 g	8 g
Per serving	~380 kcal • 34 g P	~600 kcal • 52 g P

L3 • Basque or Mediterranean classic, lightened		
So it never feels like a diet. Pick any one, cooked lighter (measured oil, more vegetables).		
- Grilled hake or cod + big salad + half a cup of white beans - Marmitako (tuna and potato stew), lighter on the oil, heavier on the vegetables - Garbanzos con espinacas (chickpeas and spinach) with a piece of cod on top - Lentejas (lentil stew) with an egg or a little fish for extra protein		
Portion so protein leads: Pilar about 450 kcal, Guillermo about 600 kcal, protein 30 to 40 g.		

Work-box tip (for the site): any lunch can go cold in a box. Easiest is a big protein salad: tuna or leftover chicken + 2 boiled eggs + a handful of chickpeas over a big salad with a spoon of oil and vinegar. Pilar ~360 kcal / 34 g P, Guillermo ~620 kcal / 58 g P.

Dinner: pick 1 (keep it light)

Lighter, especially on a low-movement evening: protein plus vegetables, little or no starch, finished about 3 hours before bed.

D1 • Euskal Okela burger + veg		
The one Guillermo wanted. A lean grass-fed patty, no bun, a big pile of veg, a small spoon of rice if you want.		
INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Lean beef patty	90 g	150 g
Vegetables	free	free
Cooked rice (optional)	40 g	60 g
Olive oil	3 g	5 g
Per serving	~300 kcal • 22 g P	~470 kcal • 35 g P

D2 • Tortilla ligera		
Light omelette, 5 minutes. Mostly egg whites plus one whole egg.		
INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
Whole egg	1	2
Egg whites (claras)	120 g	150 g
Ham cubes	30 g	40 g
Vegetables	free	free
Olive oil	5 g	8 g
Per serving	~280 kcal • 28 g P	~430 kcal • 40 g P

D3 • White fish or salmon + sautéed greens		
Seared with garlic and lemon, spinach or chard alongside. Light, fast, high protein.		
INGREDIENT	PILAR	GUILLERMO
White fish or salmon	150 g	220 g
Greens	free	free
Potato (optional, Guillermo)	none	100 g
Olive oil	5 g	8 g
Per serving	~230 kcal • 28 g P	~420 kcal • 42 g P

Snack: pick 1 (optional)

Mostly for Guillermo on a hard work day (mid-morning or before the site). Pilar usually does not need it: have it only if you moved a lot, or in place of dinner if you trained late.

- **Protein yogurt + a few berries + a few nuts** (~180 to 260 kcal, 15 to 22 g protein)
- **Kefir + blueberries + a spoon of oats** (~200 kcal, good energy before the site)
- **Cottage cheese + a piece of fruit** (~200 kcal, 20 g protein)

Allowed swaps (do not like it? swap it, do not skip the meal)

- **Protein:** chicken = turkey = rabbit = white fish = lean pork loin = lean beef = eggs = egg whites = blue fish (sardines, mackerel, a little higher in fat).
- **Carbs:** sweet potato = potato = rice = quinoa = legumes. Prefer sweet potato and legumes over white rice and pasta most days.
- **Vegetables:** free, and NOT only green. Broccoli, cauliflower, peppers, courgette, green beans, mushrooms, whatever you fancy. Cook them any way you like (oven, pan, boiled, puree).
- **Fats:** olive oil = a few nuts = a little avocado = olives. Always measured: a spoon of oil is about 120 kcal.
- Weigh rice and pasta **cooked**, everything else **raw**. Never weigh vegetables.

A sample day, so you see it lands right:

Pilar, steady day: B1 oats jar (400) + L1 oven chicken (470) + D1 burger (300) + small yogurt snack (180) = **about 1,350 kcal and 109 g protein**. On target.

Guillermo, work day: B1 oats jar (600) + L1 oven chicken (640) + D1 burger (470) + a snack (250) = **about 1,960 kcal and 152 g protein**. Add a slice of bread or an extra spoon of rice to land around 2,200 to 2,300, inside your band. On target.

Three example weeks (so you see it in action)

Just one way to rotate the menu. Each breakfast, lunch and dinner shows up a few times, beef only once or twice a week, fish often. Guillermo adds a snack on work days (Mon to Fri); on the weekend he keeps the base plan. Swap any cell for another option you fancy.

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Week 1			
Mon	B1 oats	L1 oven chicken	D3 fish + greens
Tue	B2 egg-white	L3 lentejas + cod	D1 burger
Wed	B3 chicken hash	L1 leftovers	D2 tortilla
Thu	B1 oats	L2 Euskal Okela beef	D3 fish + greens
Fri	B2 egg-white	L1 oven chicken	D1 burger
Sat	B3 chicken hash	L3 marmitako	D2 tortilla
Sun	B1 oats	L2 beef (or free meal)	D3 fish
Week 2			
Mon	B2 egg-white	L1 oven chicken	D1 burger
Tue	B1 oats	L3 garbanzos + cod	D3 fish + greens
Wed	B3 chicken hash	L1 leftovers	D2 tortilla
Thu	B2 egg-white	L2 Euskal Okela beef	D3 fish + greens
Fri	B1 oats	L1 oven chicken	D1 burger
Sat	B3 chicken hash	L3 hake + beans	D2 tortilla
Sun	B2 egg-white	L2 beef (or free meal)	D3 fish
Week 3			
Mon	B1 oats	L1 oven chicken	D2 tortilla
Tue	B3 chicken hash	L3 lentejas	D1 burger
Wed	B2 egg-white	L1 leftovers	D3 fish + greens
Thu	B1 oats	L2 Euskal Okela beef	D1 burger
Fri	B3 chicken hash	L1 oven chicken	D2 tortilla
Sat	B2 egg-white	L3 marmitako	D3 fish + greens
Sun	B1 oats	L2 beef (or free meal)	D3 fish

The weekly shopping list (2 people, small portions)

Roughly one week for the two of you, sized small on purpose. Buy it, rotate the meals, adjust next week based on what ran out.

Protein (the main spend)

- Eggs: 1 dozen, plus 3 cartons of egg whites (claras)
- Chicken: 1.5 to 2 kg (breakfast + lunch)
- Euskal Okela lean beef (1 to 2 meals): 600 to 800 g
- White fish or salmon: 800 g to 1 kg
- Tuna in water: 3 to 4 tins
- Ham cubes (serrano or turkey): 200 g
- High-protein yogurt: 1.5 kg; kefir or cottage cheese if you like

Smart carbs (small amounts)

- Sweet potato: 1.5 to 2 kg
- Potato: 1 kg
- Oats: 500 g (lasts ages)
- Rice: 500 g, or a small bag of quinoa
- Legumes: 2 tins or bags (chickpeas, lentils)
- Wholegrain bread: 1 small loaf (Guillermo, work days)

Fruit and fats

- Blueberries or other berries: 500 g (frozen is fine)
- Walnuts / almonds: 200 g
- Extra virgin olive oil, a couple of avocados

Vegetables (free, buy plenty)

- Spinach, peppers, courgette, onion, tomato, salad, cucumber, green beans, cauliflower, garlic, lemon. Whatever is fresh and cheap that week.

Optional, only if you want them: creatine, omega-3, vitamin D, magnesium.

What 45 days looks like

You are not counting to 45 recipes, you are repeating a good week about 6 times. Tick a box each day you stayed on the plan (a free meal is still a "yes"). Realistic outlook, chase the trend not miracles: **Guillermo about 3 to 5 kg** (a strong start toward the 15 kg, a 3 to 5 month job); **Pilar about 2 to 3 kg**, well on the way to the ~6 kg.

Week 1

Week 2

Week 3

Week 4

Week 5

Week 6

+ Day 43

44

45

WEEK	PESO GUILLERMO	LOST	PESO PILAR	LOST
Start	90.5 kg	-	65.9 kg	-
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Numbers are careful estimates to build awareness, not a lab measurement. The scale over 2 to 3 weeks is the real test: if the weekly average is not moving, trim a little or move a little more; if you feel wrecked, eat a bit more. Slow loss is kept loss.